

Prior Authorization Request - Outpatient Procedure

Health Plan

Humana Medicare Advantage. Plan ID: H5216-014-000. Request type: standard pre-service review.
Date of request: 2026-10-06

Member Information

Member: Karen Mitchell DOB: 1969-11-02 (age 56) Member ID: MBR-43001
Address: 309 Linden Ave, Cleveland, OH 44106
Phone: (216) 555-0103 Sex: F
Primary insurance: Humana Medicare Advantage (primary). Secondary: none on file.

Requesting Provider

Dr. Priya Raman, MD -- Pain Medicine
NPI: 1285047396
Practice: Great Lakes Pain and Neuromodulation Institute
Phone: (216) 555-0140 Fax: (216) 555-0141

Requested Service

Requested service: Permanent spinal cord stimulator pulse generator implantation (after successful trial)
CPT 63685 ICD-10: M96.1 (Postlaminectomy syndrome, not elsewhere classified); G89.4 (Chronic pain syndrome)
Planned admit date: 2026-11-10
Level of care requested: OUTPATIENT
Place of service: Ambulatory surgery center.

Submission Contact

Submitted through the provider portal by Tomas Ibarra, Authorization Coordinator.
Callback: (216) 555-0140. Supporting clinical documentation attached (6 pages including this request).

Pain Medicine Evaluation

Date: 2026-07-14. Patient: Karen Mitchell, age 56, female.

History

Chronic low back and left leg pain for 3 years since an L4-L5 laminectomy and fusion in 2023 (failed back surgery syndrome). Pain is neuropathic in character, burning and shooting into the left leg. Average pain 8/10 on a numeric rating scale. Imaging shows solid fusion, no recurrent stenosis and no surgical target. Spine surgeon agrees there is no further surgical option.

Conservative treatment tried

Gabapentin 600 mg three times daily, duloxetine 60 mg daily and tramadol 50 mg twice daily with inadequate relief. Physical therapy for 12 weeks (2025-10 to 2026-01). Three lumbar epidural steroid injections (2025-06, 2025-09, 2026-02) with relief under 3 weeks each. Cognitive behavioral pain program completed 2026-03.

Plan

Screening for spinal cord stimulation. Psychological evaluation ordered. Patient education visit scheduled.

Psychological Evaluation - Spinal Cord Stimulator Screening

Date: 2026-07-28. Evaluator: Dr. Evelyn Shaw, PsyD.

PHQ-9 score 8 (mild). GAD-7 score 6. No active substance abuse: urine drug screen consistent with prescribed medications only, no history of substance use disorder. No active psychosis. Realistic expectations about the treatment. Patient is a good candidate from a psychological standpoint. Cleared to proceed.

Patient Education and Consent Record

Date: 2026-08-04. Seen by: Dr. Priya Raman and nurse educator Mary Hobbs, RN.

An extensive discussion of risks and benefits was held, including infection, lead migration, no relief and need for revision. Written disclosure was provided. Patient signed the consent for a trial and, if the trial is successful, for permanent implantation. The same physician will perform the trial and the permanent implant.

Spinal Cord Stimulator Trial Report

Procedure: Percutaneous trial lead placement (CPT 63650), 2026-09-08. Duration of trial: 10 days, lead removed 2026-09-18.

Measure	Before trial	End of trial
Pain, left leg (NRS)	8/10	3/10
Pain, low back (NRS)	7/10	3/10
Walking tolerance	10 min	45 min
Tramadol use	100 mg/day	50 mg/day

Result: 63% reduction in target pain, 50% reduction in analgesic medication, and clear functional improvement (walking, sleeping through the night). Patient wishes to proceed to permanent implantation. Lead position confirmed by fluoroscopy on the trial day: two leads, T8-T9, adequate coverage of the painful area.

Operative Plan

Permanent implant of two percutaneous leads and a pulse generator at the ambulatory surgery center, 2026-11-10. Surgeon: Dr. Priya Raman, MD. Board certified in Pain Medicine, American Board of Anesthesiology. Hospital privileges at Lakeshore Medical Center.